The Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland

Toh 835 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཐབས་ཀྱི་ཞྭགས་པ་པདྨོ་ཕྲེང་།

The Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, known in Tibetan as Phakpa Thabkyi Zhakpa Padmo Threng and in Sanskrit, by reconstruction, as the Ārya Upāyapāśa Padmamālā, is a tantra of the Ancient, or Nyingma, tradition, closely associated with the Guhyagarbha cycle of Mahāyoga. Framed as a dialogue in which glorious Vajrasattva, after making vast offerings, questions glorious Vairocana, it serves as a condensed explanation of the meaning of the tantra's practice: the peaceful and wrathful deities of the maṇḍala, the root and action mantras of the ten wrathful ones, their mudrās, and the four kinds of ritual activity, namely pacifying, enriching, magnetizing and fierce, each with its own maṇḍala, fire offering, ritual dagger and torma. It closes with an explanation of the symbolism of the maṇḍala, in which every deity and emblem is shown to express the inseparability of the expanse of reality and knowing wisdom, and with a hymn of praise to the wrathful deities. It is Toh 835 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the section of Ancient Tantras.

The Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland.

Homage to glorious Vajrasattva.

The condensed meaning of the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland.

Then the Blessed One, glorious Vajrasattva, made offerings to the Blessed One, glorious Sarvavid Vairocana, with an unbroken expanse of offerings arisen from the blessing of awareness: celestial palaces, canopies, victory banners, pennants and parasols, the four inner offerings of the graceful goddess and the rest, and the four outer offerings of incense and the rest. He circumambulated him three times, bowed with the homage of an awareness that is not separate, sat down before him, and made this request: "Blessed One, the domain of the buddhas, the blessed ones, as known by the buddhas, the blessed ones, who have come in the three times, is not shared with the śrāvakas. By what means is it realized? Please explain it, so that one may attain the state of omniscience in this very life."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One, without saying anything, smiled, and then declared: "Great being, listen! This meaning and all phenomena, outer and inner, are alike: they are gathered into the two truths. And the two truths should be understood in this way:

The two truths are in the manner of cause and result.
When one abides in suchness,
The outer and the inner, the vessel and its contents, are utterly pure,
And all one's activity becomes the two accumulations.
The ten perfections are completed,
And as one traverses the ten grounds in sequence,
By the vajra of the awareness of equality
The grounds are joined in equality.
Through the vajra-like wisdom,
Because all phenomena are known as illusion,
The habitual tendencies toward entity and non-entity are burned;
This is also called the fire of wisdom.
The ripening of cause and result
Is not nonexistent: it is accomplished through the concordance of cause and result.
Likewise, through the wisdom of equality,
Awareness becomes the accumulation.
Among paths, this is the short path, blissful and complete;
Among means, it is the unerring and sublime one.
If one practices it, in this very life even great buddhahood,
The vajra of the three kāyas free of accepting and rejecting, is attained."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the first chapter, teaching the two truths.

"Great being, I explain these pledges (samayas) for the benefit of self and others.

Delusion, aversion, pride,
Attachment and great envy:
To hold the vow in which there is nothing to guard,
That is the vajra pledge."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the second chapter, teaching the pledges.

"Great being, these empowerments are obtained through the skill of self-awareness.

Skillful means and wisdom are the great empowerment;
With awareness one holds the vajra and the bell,
And over the phenomena of nirvāṇa and saṃsāra
One wields mastery just as one wishes."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the third chapter, on empowerment.

"Great being, the supreme offering should be understood in this way:

Offering to oneself pleases all and draws all in;
It is the medicine that benefits all.
The great-souled yogin
Should consume everything and be adorned with everything."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the fourth chapter, on offering.

"Passing beyond the ground of Universal Light,
When one has become the Lotus Eye,
From the great blessing of awareness,
In the manner of a self-arisen maṇḍala, gathering in and radiating out,
There is the great assembly of the wheel of syllables,
Free of all the major and minor marks,
With forms terrifying and fierce,
Accompanied by the swift ones and the messengers of the swift ones.
That is the vajra of the bindu.
I teach this
So that the selflessness of the person may be realized;
Let the wise become adept in it."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the fifth chapter, on the maṇḍala of meditative absorption.

"Then, great being, all domains of experience should be understood in this way:

The five great elements, too, are the tathāgatas;
Know even a single one as five times five.
They are the very nature of the three realms,
And that is also called the three kāyas.

The five wisdoms and the five classes of beings
Are, through equality, each indivisible.
When one wields mastery through mantra and mudrā,
Every domain of experience is a maṇḍala."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the sixth chapter, on the maṇḍala of images.

When Vajrasattva had heard the words "Great being," it was explained:

"The bodies of the victors of the victors,
Though they appear in every manifold form whatever,
Are everywhere like a jewel;
They are the aim and the activity, accomplished through meditation.
On the crown of the head, the eyes, the ears, the nose and the tongue
Place the five called oṃ,
And meditate on the five lords and the five ladies
In the manner of union.
On the fingers of the right hand
Place the five called hūṃ,
And meditate on the five bodhisattvas and the five female bodhisattvas
In the manner of union.
On the fingers of the left hand
Place the five called trāṃ,
And meditate on the five bodhisattvas and the five female bodhisattvas
In the manner of union.
On the toes of the left foot
Place the five called hrīḥ,
And meditate on the five bodhisattvas and the five female bodhisattvas
In the manner of union.
On the toes of the left foot
Place the five called āḥ,
And meditate on the five bodhisattvas and the five female bodhisattvas
In the manner of union."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the seventh chapter, teaching the characteristics of the deities and the sequence for arranging the maṇḍala.

Calling to Vajrasattva, "Great being, listen!", he explained:

"If the yogin who has a knowledge-holder consort
Meditates on the deities of the five clusters,
Endowed five upon five,
Everything becomes the great self.
This soft center of the precious lotus
I offer with the radiance of a smile;
Having fully aroused the delighted vajra,
Please let the cloud of the awakening mind descend.
This supreme joy of arousing the vajra,
Arouse it in the place that smiles and coils.
Nonreferential bliss and its radiance
Arise from union with the vajra-holding consort.
If the yogin who has a knowledge-holder consort
Empowers clothing and food
As substances of accomplishment
And then partakes of them, they become the supreme accomplishment.
For the yogin who has a knowledge-holder consort,
The sounds of song and of words
Are blessed as the very essence of speech;
Proclaiming them, they become the supreme accomplishment.
The yogin who has a knowledge-holder consort
Moves in dance and performance
And blesses the gathering and radiating of light;
He will attain the supreme accomplishment as well."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the eighth chapter, on achieving accomplishments.

Then from the vajra of the body, speech and mind of those blessed ones, this was drawn forth:

oṃ vajra vairocana oṃ
oṃ satva vajra hūṃ
oṃ ratna vajra trāṃ
oṃ dharma vajra hrīḥ
oṃ karma vajra āḥ
oṃ vajra akṣobhyaḥ hūṃ
oṃ vajra satva hūṃ
oṃ vajra rāja hūṃ
oṃ vajra rāga hūṃ

oṃ vajra sādhū hūṃ
oṃ vajra ratnasaṃbhava trāṃ
oṃ vajra ratna tāṃ
oṃ vajra sūrya trāṃ
oṃ vajra dhvaja trāṃ
oṃ vajra hāsa trāṃ
oṃ vajra amitābha hrīḥ
oṃ vajra tīkṣā hrīḥ
oṃ vajra cakra hrīḥ
oṃ vajra pāśa hrīḥ
oṃ vajra amoghasiddhi hā
oṃ vajra karma hā
oṃ vajra rakṣa hā
oṃ vajra yakṣa hā
oṃ vajra muṣṭi hā
hoḥ vajreśvara dhātu oṃ
oṃ vajra buddha locana hūṃ
oṃ vajra māmakī traṃ
oṃ vajra paṇḍarāvasinī hā
oṃ vajra samaya tārā hā
oṃ vajra lāsyai hūṃ
oṃ vajra dhūpe hūṃ
oṃ vajra aṃkuśa hūṃ
oṃ vajra deśvare bhyaḥ de hūṃ
oṃ vajra māle trāṃ
oṃ vajra buṣpe trāṃ
oṃ vajra pāśa trāṃ
oṃ vajra ratna rati trāṃ
oṃ vajra gītyi hrīḥ
oṃ vajra āloke hrīḥ
oṃ vajra sphoṭa hrīḥ
oṃ vajra nṛtye hā
oṃ vajra gandhe hā
oṃ vajra ghaṇḍa hā
oṃ vajra rati hā
oṃ vajra muṣṭi hūṃ
oṃ vajra muṣṭi trāṃ

oṃ vajra muṣṭi hrīḥ
oṃ vajra muṣṭi hā

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the ninth chapter, on mantras.

Calling to Vajrasattva, "Great being, listen!", he explained:

"Within the very state of the gods and goddesses,
Through mastery of the five limbs,
Every movement is a mudrā.
So the hero declared.
Now, the characteristics of the mudrās:
Within the very state of skillful means and wisdom,
Having trained the movements of the hands,
The palms joined firmly, crossed at the roots and lying side by side,
Is declared the vajra joining of palms.
The fingers interlaced inward and pressed tight,
The middle fingers, index fingers, thumbs and little fingers
Touching tip to tip in pairs and spread outward,
The ring fingers side by side and raised: this is the pledge seal.
The right toes press upon the left,
The right palm presses upon the left,
The thumb tips touch, placed in the lap:
This is the great seal of Vairocana.
From the vajra fist,
The left hand grasps the right index finger,
Joined so that each holds the other:
This is the supreme seal of union.
The two thumbs and the two little fingers
Touch tip to tip in pairs, forming a circle;
The rest radiate like light, the heels of the hands apart:
This is the mudrā of Akṣobhya.
The heels of the hands touching, the tips of the middle fingers joined,
The index fingers bent at the joint and set against the middle fingers,
The ring fingers and thumbs touching at the tips, the little fingers hidden:
This is the mudrā of Ratnasambhava.
The middle, index and ring fingers touching at the tips,
The little fingers should be joined along their sides,

The thumb tips touching, forming a circle:
This is the mudrā of Amitābha.
With palms joined, then each spread apart,
Moving them, one makes them like a wheel
And has them revolve with a garland of lightning:
This is the mudrā of Amoghasiddhi.
These kings of mudrās
Are bound at the heart, with conviction in them as such;
Gathering in and radiating out, freeing and releasing into space,
They are taught as for the rites and as common to all.
Holding the vajra and the bell,
At the heart, and resting oneself at the hip,
Glancing sideways with a playful air:
This is the great seal of Vajrasattva.
The hands crossed and held in fists,
The two middle fingers extended,
The index fingers made like hooks:
This is the great seal of Vajrarāja.
From the hands held in fists,
The left thumb and index finger touching at the tips,
The right middle finger extended and raised:
This is the great seal of Vajrarāga.
The fingers of both hands,
At the first joint of each middle finger,
Are inserted at the tips from the four sides:
This is the great seal of Vajrasādhu.
The heels of the hands joined, the middle fingers touching at the tips,
The thumbs, index and ring fingers bent at the joints,
Beautiful in their purity, the little fingers hidden:
This is the great seal of Vajraratna.
The thumbs and little fingers touching at the tips
Should be linked as in a chain;
If the rest are made like rays of light,
This is the great seal of Vajrasūrya.
The left forearm raised,
From the vajra fist,
One should grasp it at the elbow with the right:

This is the great seal of Vajradhvaja.
The right placed upon the left,
The finger joints bent and touching,
One should hold them straight in front of the mouth:
This is the great seal of Vajrahāsa.
The fingertips of the left
Gathered so that they all but touch,
The right made as though opening them:
This is the great seal of Vajradharma.
The right forearm raised,
The thumb and little finger touching at the tips,
The remaining three should be raised as well;
The left fist resting at the hip:
This is the great seal of Vajratīkṣṇa.
The hands crossed, the tips interlaced,
The tips of the two thumbs touching,
Made as though turning:
This is the great seal of Vajracakra.
From the fingers interlaced inward,
The middle fingers touching at the tips, the index fingers joined,
The thumbs pressing upon the middle fingers:
This is the great seal of Vajrabhāṣa.
From the wrists crossed,
At the first joints of the two middle fingers
The fingers rest, as on the ground, on the four sides:
This is the mudrā of Vajrakarma.
The fingers of both hands
Woven together as on a loom,
The two thumbs should be raised:
This is the mudrā of Vajrarakṣa.
From the vajra fist,
The two index fingers raised,
One should hold them at the two cheeks:
This is the great seal of Vajrayakṣa.
From the vajra fists,
Crossed, their faces joined together,
One should hold them firmly at the heart:

This is the great seal of Vajramuṣṭi.
Having meditated on the mudrās of the families,
Through these conceptions of the hands,
One should give rise to conviction in gathering in and radiating out,
And bind them, and release them into space.
The thumbs and little fingers touching within,
The middle fingers joined at the tips, the four others raised,
The heels of the hands touching as though holding a vajra:
This is the mudrā of Vajradhara.
The heels of the hands joined, the thumbs and index fingers joined at the tips,
The little fingers set straight into the eye of the index fingers,
The rest made like a trident:
This is the mudrā of Vajralocanā.
The left forearm raised,
The fingers made like an utpala lotus,
One should hold the fingers of the right:
This is the mudrā of Vajratārā.
The knees of the two legs
And the elbows of the two arms
Brought together, and the hands raised:
This is the mudrā of Samantabhadrī.
The vajra fists resting at the hips,
Leaning the body to the right,
Gazing with eyes of desire:
This is the mudrā of Vajralāsyā.
The left is made cupped,

And the right hand grasps the elbow,
Turning, with the fingers radiating:
This is the mudrā of Vajradhūpā.
The two hands joined back to back,
From the vajra fists,
The little fingers linked and the index fingers raised:
This is the seal of Vajrāṅkuśī.
The little fingers linked as in a chain,
The fingers each raised separately,
The palms stretched out, gazing at them:

This is the mudrā of Vajratārā.
The ring fingers and the two thumbs
Touching tip to tip in pairs,
Drawn up straight before the forehead:
This is the mudrā of Vajramālā.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the tenth chapter, on mudrās.

Then the eight bodhisattvas, Vajrapāṇi and the rest, together with most of the retinue, praised the gods and goddesses of the maṇḍala in harmonious melody:

"oṃ In the boundless worlds of the ten directions,
Whatever victors dwell, together with their retinues,
The blessing of accomplishment of the unsurpassed gods and goddesses
Is beyond conception.
The sixteen sattvas, lords of the families,
The sixteen female sattvas, mothers of the families,
The mighty wrathful gods and wrathful goddesses,
Have the world protectors as their messengers.
oṃ Through your great former vow,
All the worlds without exception
Are joined into the field of the victors;
So join me to the great seal!
oṃ Great heroes endowed with power,
Through the blessing of great compassion,
Please bless my superior intentions
That they may be accomplished.
oṃ Homage to the one who joins the three realms into a pure field!
Homage to the Body of Dharma, beyond all reference!
Homage to the Body of Perfect Enjoyment!
Homage to the Body of Emanation, appearing as anything at all!"

Having praised him in this way, they entered into his very heart. Then, in play, he entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption of the wrathful ones and taught the ritual of the wrathful ones.

Then Vajrapāṇi said this to the Blessed One, glorious Vajrasattva: "Blessed One, in the present and in future times, naked ascetics, wandering ascetics

and others, through the rites of their own spells, will incite worldly gods such as Mahādeva (Śiva), the mighty yakṣas and all the sorceresses, and will create obstacles to the lives of sentient beings, harm them, and cause them great suffering. By what means is this to be turned back? How are their workings to be cut off?"

He declared: "Vajrapāṇi, listen! This was taught in the past by the lord of the vajra body, speech and mind of all the tathāgatas. It turns back even all the secret mantras made by you yourself, Vajrapāṇi, and all the secret mantras that bring existence to an end; it suppresses them; it cuts off their workings. What need is there to speak of others, such as wandering ascetics?"

Then the Blessed One entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption of the vajra weapon and, from the vajra of body, speech and mind, spoke this, called "Turning Back and Suppressing Secret Mantras and Cutting Off Their Workings":

oṃ vajra jvala vajra hūṃ mantra suṃbhani oṃ vajra jvala hūṃ oṃ brūṃ hūṃ brūṃ trūṃ brūṃ hūṃ brūṃ hrāṃḥ brūṃ ā brūṃ

As soon as he had spoken this, a great rain of weapons fell from the ten directions, and Vajrapāṇi himself fell on his face and vomited blood. All the gods and yakṣas, too, fainted, and their bodies were cut into pieces. Then the Blessed One, knowing that their workings had been cut off, raised them up again:

oṃ vajra satva rāja jha

Then the Blessed One said to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, you too must not transgress this. If all your retinue were to transgress it, they would all be destroyed. Likewise, Vajrapāṇi, you must command all the gods and yakṣas."

Then Vajrapāṇi said: "Blessed One, here it is I who tame all the three realms of existence, I who tame all the mighty, I who crush the pride of all the mighty. Just as the Blessed One Śākyamuni gave me the name Vajrapāṇi because I possess might and strength, so here, when this mantra was uttered through the blessing of the Blessed One Vajrasattva, even I vomited blood and fell; what need is there to speak of others? This is hard to transgress. I shall likewise command the gods and yakṣas."

Then the Blessed One explained the rite for accomplishing this secret mantra in future times.

From maṃ, upon a sun maṇḍala,
Invite the Great Glorious Heruka.
His body is a deep smoky color,
His hair reddish black, in matted locks.
He has three heads and six arms;
The heads are red, smoky and black.
What he holds in his three right hands
Is the great club of the Stira,
And a great conch filled with red,
Stirred with a vajra: imagine him drinking it.
What he holds in his three left hands
Is a noose of the Stira's entrails,
And he holds the great blood of a garuḍa,
And from the belly of the slender Stira
He draws out the lungs and heart from within and devours them.
On his crown is Vairocana himself, oṃ;
On the right shoulder, akṣabhyaḥ hūṃ;
On the left, ratnasambhava trāṃ;
On the right foot, amoghasiddhi āḥ;
On the left, amitābha, hrīḥ.
From bhuṃ, upon a vajra wheel,
Visualize the vajra ones as the spell goddesses:
Gaurī and Caurī,
Pramohā and Vetālī,
And further Vyāghrīmukhā,
Siṃhamukhā and the other swift ones.
Upon the Stira, in a crouching stance,
Gazing, they remain as if staking it down.
Ha ha! Then, in an instant,
Together with the spell itself and the dispatching of curses,
Visualize them as messengers for summoning.
On cloth, on birch bark, or on grass,
Draw the image of the wrathful one,
Or else bind it with black thread.
With the great laughter "ha ha,"
Singing the song that urges on the vajra,
Send forth the messengers.
Then, seizing the spell,

And whatever abides in the grass effigy,
With the wheel and the other weapons
Destroy them into powder.
vajra cakra hūṃ
Having chopped them into powder,
With the skull cup and the bow,
In a triangular fire pit with a door,
Kindle the fire called raṃ,
Summon the sage with his retinue by beckoning,
And burn the spell.
When one thus joins the deity with oneself,
One should be furnished with the five kinds of attire.
"Great mātṛkās, enjoy the flesh!
The flesh of bhūtas is tastier than porridge;
The blood of bhūtas is tastier than beer;
Great mātṛkās, enjoy the blood!"
With song, dance and peals of laughter,
Make offerings to each and accomplish them.
Whatever sentient being has been seized,
Bind it with black thread,
And then cut that into pieces.
Then, for that person, as before,
In order to secure their life, with the five grains
One makes an arrangement at the five places.
Protect the sentient being who was led astray.
Hot and rough firewood,
Meat, beer and the implements,
Black and hot, are combined
And offered to the great gods.
Then, when the rites are accomplished,
With laughter such as "ha ha,"
With song and with the vajra staff,
Dissolve the deities into oneself.
This protects oneself
And accomplishes all rites.

In the east is the sorceress Gaurī, blue in color, with two arms. In the left she holds a skull bowl filled with red sandalwood; in the right she holds a staff made of a small corpse. If one recites oṃ vajra gaurī jaḥ jaḥ hūṃ one thousand and eight times and entrusts her with the task, she can summon even the buddhas; what need is there to speak of others? Having entrusted her with the words "Bring so-and-so!", one recites oṃ rulu rulu hūṃ bhyo over the torma and the argha of great red sandalwood, and raises the argha three times.

In the south is Caurī, yellow in color, drawing a bow and arrow in her hands. If one entrusts her with oṃ vajra caurī hūṃ jaḥ one thousand and eight times, she can steal even the might of Vajrapāṇi until not a speck of it remains; what need is there to speak of others?

In the west is Pramohā, red, holding a makara banner in her hand. If one recites oṃ vajra pramoha hūṃ jaḥ one thousand and eight times and entrusts her with the task, even Vajrapāṇi will lay aside his own might and come under control; what need is there to speak of others?

In the north is Vetālī, black in color, holding a small corpse in her left hand and eating it, and brandishing a vajra in her right. If one recites oṃ vajra vaittali hūṃ jaḥ one thousand and eight times and entrusts her with the task, even all the accomplishments, worldly and beyond the world, are accomplished; what need is there to speak of petty worldly practices?

In the southeast is Pukkasī, reddish yellow in color, with her two hands drawing out the entrails of a small corpse and eating them. If one recites oṃ vajra pukkasi hūṃ jaḥ one thousand and eight times and entrusts her with the task, she can bind and drag off even Vajrapāṇi; what need is there to speak of binding and devouring others?

In the southwest is Ghasmarī, green in color, holding in her left hand a skull bowl filled with red sandalwood, stirring it with a vajra and drinking. If one recites oṃ vajra ghasmari hūṃ jaḥ one thousand and eight times and entrusts her with the task, she can intoxicate even Vajrapāṇi; what need is there even to speak of others?

In the northwest is Vajrakarma, green in color, holding a small corpse with both hands and eating its heart. If one recites oṃ vajra karma hūṃ jaḥ one thousand and eight times and entrusts her with the task, every rite one has to perform will be accomplished.

In the northeast is Caṇḍālī, pale yellow in color, holding in her right hand a skull bowl made from a small corpse and in her left a corpse staff. If one recites oṃ vajra caṇḍali hūṃ jaḥ one thousand and eight times and entrusts her with the task, she makes the line of descent increase even for the sterile and for eunuchs; what need is there to speak of increasing the line of descent, the lifespan and the power of those whose faculties are complete and unimpaired?

When urging these sorceresses to their activity, the offering of argha and torma is done as stated above.

If they are wrathful, all of them hold blazing tridents in their hands and in the left carry a small drum. Their seat is dark purple-black fire. Their bodies are black in color, adorned with clusters of drops of blood, grease and ash, their waists bound with entrails, and they wear golden hides draped across them; their bodies are adorned with srodta and aja. The host of naked ones blazes dark purple-black, the left hand carrying a small drum and the right dark purple fire. All of them, black in color, burn up the world system, and having consumed it, they are dissolved back into the body of the Great Glorious One.

Next, I shall explain the outer stage.

In the east is Siṃhamukhā, yellow in color, holding a small corpse in her mouth, her right and left hands crossed, with the head of a lion. In the south is Vyāghrīmukhā, red in color, her two hands crossed, gazing at a corpse lying before her, with the head of a tiger. In the west is Śṛgālamukhā, black in color, holding a small corpse with her two hands and licking it with her tongue, with the head of a fox. In the north is Śvānamukhā, blue in color, tearing open a corpse with her two hands and gazing into it, with the head of a dog. In the southeast is Gṛdhramukhā, dark red in color, holding the entrails of a small corpse in her mouth, a skull bowl in her right hand and a knife in her left, with the head of a vulture. In the southwest is Kaṅkamukhā, whitish red in color, a corpse slung over her left shoulder and held by its feet, her right hand holding its head, with the head of a kaṅka bird, its beak long, with a hooked tuft, and red-crested. In the northwest is Kākamukhā, black in color, with the head of a crow, holding a corpse in her beak, her left hand holding a lotus skull bowl. In the northeast is Ulūkamukhā, of various colors, her left hand holding a great conch filled with blood from which she drinks, her right hand holding a vajra hook, with the head of an owl.

The inner ring is surrounded by a retinue of owls. Its outer ring is surrounded by a retinue of crows. Its outer ring is surrounded by a retinue of long-beaked kaṅka birds. Its outer ring is surrounded by a retinue of vultures. All of them, upon a heap of many corpses fresh and old, show nothing but the manner of fighting in order to stake down the corpse.

Their heart mantras are these:

hūṃ ha he phaṭ hūṃ

Each syllable of all of these is recited four times. With hūṃ the principal is generated. With hā the inner goddesses are generated. With he the outer goddesses are generated. With phaṭ all are urged into wrath. With hūṃ the blazing light rays of the wisdom of all of them are made to pervade the ten directions.

"Wise goddesses, and lord of the assembly,
Homage to glorious Heruka!
Those who despise the master,
Those who obstruct the yogins,
Those who tear apart the pledge-keeping allies,
And those who quarrel with their vajra kin:
You have crushed them into dust,
And uprooted all ill will without remainder."

When the Great Glorious One went to the great assembly in the place of the seat and the gathering, through the splendor of the wrath of body, speech and mind he uprooted all the vicious ones entirely, and, in great enjoyment, swaggering, he sang a swaggering song. With this melody that delights all, he gave them delight.

Binding the vajra lotus mudrā at the forehead, he leaped up, and the whole retinue, having become naked, tore loose their hair and ran about, and he spoke this mantra:

oṃ e ārali hoḥ hriṃ hriṃ hriṃ hriṃ

Then, going into the assembly, he looked upon the whole retinue with eyes wide open and uttered the sign of a smile, the sound ha ha saṃ saṃ, and the whole retinue, with one voice, praised the principal in this melody:

"How wonderful! The meaning of the Dharma has arisen:
The meaning of the Dharma, pure and without self,
An abode equal to space.

Homage to the Vajra King!"

Pleased by this praise, the principal looked upon the whole retinue and, granting the pledge, sang this melody:

kha ga lya śa ta ba ka a la la hoḥ mahā pañca amṛta kha raṃ yogini kha raṃ ṭākini a la la hoḥ bhaga pān kha kha kha

The goddesses beat drums and sing a melody, the words of the three tantras:

te gheṃ te gheṃ te gheṃ te gheṃ te gheṃ te gheṃ gheṃ gheṃ gheṃ

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the eleventh chapter, on cutting off spells.

"Great being, listen!
In the expanse of gathering and radiating light rays
Blazing like the fire at the end of an eon
Dwell the great wrathful ones,
Standing with legs extended and drawn in.
The great Heruka at the center
Has nine heads and eighteen arms,
Spreads wings studded with vajras,
And displays eight legs.
The wrathful ones of his maṇḍala
Have three heads, six arms and wings,
And six legs, upon a vajra rock,
With the world protectors bowing down to them.
Their messengers and servants
Are vajra sorceresses of fierce demeanor,
Many, with terrifying forms;
They accomplish anything at all."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twelfth chapter, on all the maṇḍalas of the wrathful ones.

"The great Vajrarākṣasī
Appears as the great terrifying one;
Her arms, too, are like those of the great rākṣasa,
Matching, and her legs are the same.
In such a maṇḍala,
When one has thrown a precious flower,

The deity on whom it lands,
If one strives, will without doubt be accomplished.
Toward virtuous and nonvirtuous phenomena
One should not be especially attached;
Having entered the river of awareness of equality,
One acts without obstruction in anything.
Taking up the vajra staff,
One should beckon with it five times.
Then imagine the maṇḍala as present,
And present a great offering.
With a mere snap of the fingers
The swift one goes anywhere in the ten directions.
Those who ride upon them and travel,
The crow-headed one and all the rest,
When hidden by the concealing goddess,
No mighty god or demon whatever
Is able to see them;
So how could anyone else see them?
The work of the urging one is to cast onto others;
The work of the swift one is to go and arrive;
The work of the killing one is to accomplish;
The going one goes even without each being accomplished."

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirteenth chapter, on Vajrarākṣasī.

oṃ vajra krodha samaya hūṃ oṃ vajra krodha samaya phaṭ oṃ vajra krodha samaya stvaṃ ehyehi bhagabān jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ rulu rulu rulu hūṃ

oṃ vajra krodha śrī heruka hūṃ a a a hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra krodha hūṃ kāra hūṃ garja garja garja hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra krodha vijaya hūṃ hana hana hana hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra krodha nīla daṇḍa hūṃ daha daha daha hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra krodha yamāntā ka hūṃ baca paca paca hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra krodha ārya cala hūṃ bandha bandha bandha hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra krodha taya grība hūṃ hulu hulu hu hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra krodha aparājita hūṃ tiṣṭha tiṣṭha tiṣṭha hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra krodha amṛta kuṇḍali hūṃ cchinda cchinda cchinda hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra krodha trailokya bijaya hūṃ bhinda bhinda bhinda hūṃ phaṭ

oṃ vajra krodha mehā bala hūṃ sphoṭa sphoṭa sphoṭa hūṃ phaṭ

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the fourteenth chapter, gathering together the root mantras and the action mantras of the ten wrathful ones.

oṃ vajra krodhe hūṃ hala hala hala hala ha hūṃ
oṃ vajra krodha hūṃ rulu rulu rulu rulu rulu hūṃ
ma ma ma ma hūṃ bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo hūṃ jaḥ jaḥ jaḥ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the fifteenth chapter, on the mantras of Vajrarākṣasī.

Once sameness has been realized,
All urging and all shaking, too,
Are mudrā, so the king has said.
In brief, they are to be understood like this.

The hands, palms joined, are raised upward;
The feet, soles joined, are planted downward;
The four great joints are to be pressed firm;
The head and the secret organ are visualized as the heart essence;
A vajra of one point, of nine points,
And of eleven points as well is visualized:
This is the mudrā of the great Heruka,
So the hero has said.

The hands, palms joined, are raised upward;
The feet set apart, stretched and bent,
Dancing with a striding stance:
This is the great seal of hūṃ.

The feet set apart, soles planted downward,
The hands set apart and dancing,
Making offering in that stance:
This is the mudrā of Mahābala.

The left foot is wound about the right,
The hands are whirled in the manner of a dance,
And the palms are clapped together fiercely:
This is the mudrā of Vijaya.

With the thumbs of the right and left hands
Pressing the little fingers at the base of the nails,
Raised as though brandishing:
This is the mudrā of Nīladaṇḍa.

The right hand, made into a fist,
Brandished as though to strike,
And the left resting on the hip:
This is the mudrā of Yamāntaka.

The right hand, palm open,
Brandished as though to slap,
And the left made as though seizing:
This is the mudrā of the protector Acala.

With the palms of the hands joined together,
The middle fingers should be crossed at the back;
The two thumbs, set apart, are raised;
Placed on the crown of the head, this is the seal of Hayagrīva.

The right foot planted downward,
The right hand raised upward,
The left foot and hand lifted:
This is the mudrā of Aparājita.

Both right and left hands resting on the hips,
The feet together, leaping:
This is called the mudrā of Amṛtakuṇḍalin,
So the great hero has said once more.

The right and left hands crossed,
The feet stretched and bent:
This is called the mudrā of Trailokyavijaya,
So the protector, the hero, has said once more.

The right and left hands shaken,
And the body, too, shaken fiercely:
This is the mudrā of the vajra sorceresses,
So the guide has said.

Having bound these mudrās,
If one leaps fiercely in the great stance,
One will leap clear of the three realms.

Moreover, every state without exception
Will be accomplished, without any doubt,
So the great being of awareness has said.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the sixteenth chapter, on the mudrās.

At the center of the great wheel of eight spokes
The Heruka is invited;
In front, hūṃ too is invited;
Behind, Mahābala is invited;
And upon the spokes of the wheel
The ten as well, in their proper order,
Are invited each to its own place.
Having offered the red arghya,
Other offerings, too, should be presented.
Having praised them with vajra song,
One should then accomplish the rites.
The Vajra of Aversion with its retinue,
Wrathful, in a single instant destroys
All the world realms throughout the infinite expanse;
There is nothing whatever not destroyed.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the seventeenth chapter, on the rites.

By the practice of the vajra sorceresses
He is summoned in a single instant;
If he is then fully laid out in the manner of one staked down,
Even a god will be destroyed.
When the sorceresses, the owl-headed one and the rest,
Are sent against him,
His eyes and ears, nose and tongue,
And his mind are seized, and his meditation falls away.
When the sorceresses are sent against him,
They cut off his practice;
If one secretly meditates on delusion,
His practice falls away and breaks apart.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the eighteenth chapter, on fierce rites.

In an open, three-cornered fire pit,
Furnished with vajra bow and arrow
And fully adorned with skull cups,
If he is invited and burned, even a god will die.
If the sorceresses are dispatched to summon him
And he is burned in all the hearths, he will die at once.
With meats mixed with the burnt offering
One makes offering to all the deities.
Singing the vajra song:
"The flesh of bhūtas is most delicious,
The blood of bhūtas is most delicious,
The bones of bhūtas are delicious;
Partake of them, and may all be delighted!"

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the nineteenth chapter, on the fierce fire offering.

Of iron or of black wood,
With a head like a lance, its point three-edged,
Visualizing the wrathful gods and goddesses,
If it is driven in, even a god will be destroyed.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twentieth chapter, on the fierce ritual dagger.

Iron filings, poison, and stone powder,
Kneaded with blood and mixed together,
With a decoction of mung beans and other ingredients:
If the torma is cast with the rite, he will be destroyed.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twenty-first chapter, on the fierce torma.

In the mortar that is the maṇḍala of the wrathful goddess,
Pounded with the hammer of the wrathful god:
If one visualizes the vajra mortar and pestle,
Even a god will be pounded.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twenty-second chapter, on the fierce rites.

Those who have been accomplished by fierce action,
The doors of the five paths of saṃsāra having been shut,
Their consciousness gathered and wrapped up by hūṃ,
Are cast by phaṭ into the womb of union
Of the five lords and the five ladies,
The male and female sattvas,
And the wrathful gods and goddesses,
In the supreme abode, unsurpassed Akaniṣṭha.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twenty-third chapter, on conveying them to the abode.

In the half-moon maṇḍala of eight spokes
The wrathful gods and goddesses are invited,
And worshiped with offerings, songs, and so forth.
Then one should undertake the rites.
The Vajra of Desire with its retinue,
Through desire, in an instant brings under its power
All the world realms throughout the infinite expanse;
There is nothing whatever not brought under its power.
Having dispatched the vajra sorceresses
And summoned him, by the great wrathful one,
In the manner of desire, from his body
His courage and splendor are gathered, and it is accomplished.
Having dispatched the sorceresses,
If one visualizes his eyes, ears, nose, and tongue,
And his body, speech, and mind transformed,
He will become attractive and delightful to all.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twenty-fourth chapter, teaching the rites of magnetizing.

An open half-moon fire pit
Should be adorned with a vajra lasso.
Then the deities are invited,
And if harmful conceptual thoughts are burned, it is accomplished.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twenty-fifth chapter, on the magnetizing fire offering.

Of copper, or of red-colored wood,
With a knotted head and a half-moon point,

Visualizing on its head the retinue of wrathful ones,
If it is driven in, he will certainly come under one's power.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twenty-sixth chapter, explaining the rite of the magnetizing ritual dagger.

Copper powder and molasses,
Red rice, and so forth:
Mixing them, one should cast the torma.
By seeing it, he will certainly come under one's power.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twenty-seventh chapter, on the magnetizing torma.

Within the maṇḍala of the wrathful goddesses,
If one visualizes the maṇḍala of the wrathful gods,
Even a god will come under one's power.
That is great bliss.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twenty-eighth chapter, on the magnetizing practice.

In the square maṇḍala of eight spokes
The deities with their retinues are invited,
And worshiped with offerings, songs, and so forth.
Then one should undertake the rites.
"Vajra of Pride with your retinue,
Throughout all the world realms of the infinite expanse,
Increase, in a single instant,
Glory and great splendor!"
If one visualizes the wrathful gods and goddesses with their retinues
And the vajra sorceresses with their retinues
Increasing glory and splendor,
He will become a great being.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the twenty-ninth chapter, on the rites of enriching.

An open square fire pit
Should be adorned with a vajra wheel.
Then, having invited the deities,
Worship them by burning, and visualize glory increasing!

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirtieth chapter, on the enriching fire offering.

Of gold, or of yellow wood,
With a knotted head and a four-cornered point:
Visualizing the deities, one should drive it in.
This is auspicious for the rites of enriching.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirty-first chapter, on the enriching ritual dagger.

Gold powder, yellow rice,
Milk, and honey: this torma
Is the torma that brings increase.
The wise one, visualizing increase, gives it.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirty-second chapter, on the enriching torma.

Within the maṇḍala of the goddesses
One visualizes the maṇḍala of the god complete.
If one visualizes the mind of awakening radiating out,
This accomplishes the rite of enriching.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirty-third chapter, on the enriching practice.

In the round maṇḍala of eight spokes
The deities with their retinues are invited,
And worship is made with white offering water.
Then one should undertake the rites.
The Vajra of Delusion with its retinue
In a single instant pacifies
All the world realms throughout the infinite expanse.
Homage to the one accomplished in peace!
If one visualizes all the deities with their retinues
Pacifying every disturbance,
Everything in a single instant
Will become peaceful, without any doubt.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirty-fourth chapter, on the rites of pacifying.

An open round fire pit
Should be adorned with a vajra lotus.
Driving in six white ritual daggers,
One invites the deities and worships them with powders and so forth.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirty-fifth chapter, on the pacifying fire offering.

On a ritual dagger white in color,
With a knotted head and a rounded point,
Visualizing the deities, one should drive it in.
This is auspicious for the rites of pacifying.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirty-sixth chapter, on the pacifying ritual dagger.

Silver and white cooked rice:
The torma mixed with milk
Is the torma that brings peace.
The wise one, visualizing peace, casts it.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirty-seventh chapter, on the pacifying torma.

Within the maṇḍala of the goddesses
One should visualize the accomplishment of the god.
If one visualizes everything pacified through blessing,
All the deities, too, will become peaceful.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirty-eighth chapter, on the rites of pacifying conduct.

The mudrā without characteristics,
And the mudrās arising directly from it,
Are not fixed, so the hero has said.
If the wise one varies them as he likes, they are accomplished.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the thirty-ninth chapter, summarizing the rites.

By fierce rites everything will be tamed;
By magnetizing, supreme wealth too is accomplished;
By enriching, splendor fully increases;
By pacifying, supreme bliss too is accomplished.

From the Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, the fortieth chapter, on the benefits of accomplishing the rites.

The name of this maṇḍala is the maṇḍala of the Gathering of Great Power. Making the base of the maṇḍala round signifies the dharmadhātu (the expanse of phenomena), free of elaboration. Making the wheel with spokes and corners, set within the round base, signifies that, while the dharmadhātu remains free of elaboration, the deities of blessing, the goddesses, the wrathful gods, the wrathful goddesses, the messengers, and the rest radiate forth of themselves. In another respect, it signifies that, while the dharmadhātu is free of conceptual thought, omniscient wisdom, which knows whatever there is, is spontaneously present.

Making the outer border square signifies that great bliss expands through mastery over all the worlds, both the container and its contents, of the ten directions. The five goddesses at the center face outward: the goddesses are the blessing of the nearness of the expanse itself, and this signifies that the sattvas see the nearness of the expanse itself. The five sattvas facing inward signifies looking upon the nearness of the expanse itself. The other sattvas facing outward means that the expanse itself is at no time inert like a stone, but is endowed with knowing wisdom, and that the sattva itself is not other than the expanse. The other female sattvas facing inward means that knowing wisdom is not conceptual thought with regard to things and all the rest, but is endowed with the expanse itself, and that the expanse itself, too, is not other than knowing wisdom. In another respect, the sattvas facing outward signifies mastery over all the worlds, container and contents; the female sattvas facing inward signifies that all the worlds, container and contents, are gathered under one's power; and the sattvas and female sattvas, outer and inner, gazing at one another means bringing delight. All the wrathful gods and goddesses facing outward signifies crushing and taming outer things, adversaries, and the like.

Here the expanse is like the disk of the sun. Knowing wisdom is like the sun's light, shining and clear. Its blessing is like its being warm and gentle. Crushing and taming outer things and the like is like trees and plants being dried out and burnt. The goddesses and female sattvas are the meaning of the awareness of the dharmadhātu appearing to the mind. The gods and sattvas are the seeing of the meaning that appears in the expanse. That, in the state of blessing of appearing and seeing within the expanse itself, the nature of things and adversaries is spontaneously crushed, and they are tamed by being

joined to the expanse, signifies that the wrathful gods and goddesses perform the four rites as their very nature and protect the world with compassion. The world protectors and the rest abide, through blessing, as messengers. In another respect, this signifies the teaching that the mighty worldly gods are gathered as the retinue.

The eight auspicious symbols are auspicious because, though one has mastery over all and engages in saṃsāra, one does not become bound by the afflictions, and though one engages in nirvāṇa, one does not fall into the one-sided peace of the śrāvakas, and so one is overpowered by nothing at all. Among them, the endless knot is the auspiciousness of possessing knowing wisdom. The wheel is the auspiciousness of mastery over all and of turning the wheel of Dharma. The jewel is the auspiciousness of possessing what is inexhaustible. The lotus is the auspiciousness of not being seized by saṃsāra. The parasol is the auspiciousness of not being tormented by the afflictions. The vase is the auspiciousness of possessing the supreme nectar. The conch is the auspiciousness of proclaiming a sound that overawes all the doors. The fish signifies that, though one acts for the benefit of the beings of the five paths, there is no fear.

The four swirls are the blessing of the five families; or they show that the beings of the five paths possess the nature of the Tathāgata; or they mean acting for their benefit through compassion. In another respect, they signify that everything is gathered under one's power.

Here the chief goddesses, each with a retinue of five, do nothing at all. The twenty sattvas and female sattvas are like a parent to an only child toward all. By the force of acting in this way, the wrathful gods and goddesses with their retinues are, toward all outer and inner things, like a hunter who has sighted game. In this way, by the force of aversion, everything is joined to the expanse itself. When there is abundance, though one engages in the things of saṃsāra, it is great enjoyment, and since one does not become bound by the afflictions, to practice in this way is desire. The dharmadhātu being by nature secret is jealousy. Dharmatā being free of elaboration is delusion. Such dharmatā being victorious over the three realms is pride.

Here, the blessing of the chief lord with his retinue of five pervades everything, yet its immediate seat is the head, the front from the chest upward, and the back from the base of the spine upward. The blessing of Akṣobhya with his retinue of five is the right hand and the right side of the ribs. The blessing of

Ratnasambhava with his retinue of five is the left hand and the left side of the ribs. The blessing of Amitābha with his retinue of five is from the left foot up to the left waist. The blessing of Amoghasiddhi with his retinue of five is from the right foot up to the left waist. All the wrathful gods and goddesses follow the blessing of their respective families. In this way, each of the five retinues also becomes fivefold. Everything that performs the function of solidity is the vajra family. Everything that performs the function of warmth is the jewel family. Everything that performs the function of moisture is the lotus family. Everything that performs the function of movement is the karma family. What is accomplished in general from these in equal portions, actually present, is the tathāgata family.

The blessing of She Who Is the Self of All, with her retinue of five, is everything that has become central. The absence of an intrinsic nature of solidity is the blessing of Locanā with her retinue of five. The absence of an intrinsic nature of warmth is the blessing of Māmakī with her retinue of five. The absence of an intrinsic nature of moisture is the blessing of Pāṇḍaravāsinī with her retinue of five. The absence of an intrinsic nature of movement is the blessing of Tārā with her retinue of five. That which is able to perform a function as its purpose is the sattva. Likewise, the absence of intrinsic nature is the female sattva. Awareness of it in this way is the wrathful gods and goddesses. All gathering in and sending forth, too, should be done in this way. All outer and inner phenomena, too, should be viewed in this way.

When the glorious Vairocana had spoken thus, the many hundreds of thousands of the hosts of Vajrakumāra rejoiced and offered praise in these words:

hūṃ
Within the expanse where light rays gather and radiate,
Blazing like the fire at the end of the eon,
Abide the wrathful gods and goddesses,
Their bodies forms that transform into anything at all.

hūṃ
The hair on your heads, dark brown and matted,
Coils upward and blazes to the peak of existence;
Your unequal eyes, wrathfully furrowed and glaring,
Are the sign of taming wrong views.

hūṃ
Baring your fangs, grinding and gnashing,
Is the way of cutting the root of birth and death.
The blessing of body, speech, and mind
Appears as any of the various mudrās.

hūṃ
The blessing of compassion gathers like clouds;
The light rays of loving-kindness flash like lightning;
The sound of your terrifying voice resounds like thunder;
Emanated thunderbolts fall like rain.

hūṃ
By your great vow of old,
You seek out great faults in the māras,
You make great mockery of the obstructors,
And you grant accomplishments to those who keep the samaya.

hūṃ
Through the blessing of great compassion,
Bestow your blessing upon me,
And I pray that you bless me
That my higher aspirations may be accomplished.

Coiling, and the ornaments, too, coiling:
Being the nature of mind, you have no body;
You are union beyond sound,
Wisdom free of thought.

hūṃ
Homage to the deities who crush the three realms of existence!
Homage to those wrathful within the state of sameness!
Homage to those who enjoy through wrath!
Homage to the wrathful ones, the vajras gathering and radiating!

Having praised in this way, they entered into his heart and vanished from sight.

The Noble Lasso of Skillful Means, the Lotus Garland, is complete.

Here is volume Ga of the Ancient Tantras.

Translator's Notes

• "Universal Light" is the eleventh ground (Samantaprabhā); "Lotus Eye" is rendered literally and appears to name a further, higher ground or state beyond it. In chapter seven the Tibetan reads "when Vajrasattva had heard," where the parallel formula in chapter eight reads "calling to Vajrasattva"; it is translated as written. The Tibetan also gives "the left foot" twice in chapter seven, where one would expect the right foot for the first; this is translated as written. "The five great" in chapter six is taken as the five great elements. Chapter eight contains the language of sexual yoga (the lotus and vajra, the descent of the awakening mind) as is usual in this class of tantra.
• In the description of the Vajrakarma mudrā, the phrase rendered "as on the ground" (literally "the fingers of the earth") is obscure and may reflect a copyist's slip. In the Vajralāsyā mudrā, the word taken as "the body" is uncertain in the Tibetan. "Rites" in the line on the kings of mudrās renders a word that may instead refer to the action seal (karmamudrā).
• The word rendered "the Stira" (a figure struck, bound and devoured, apparently the victim or effigy of the rite) is unidentified, and so is "srodta and aja" in the description of the wrathful sorceresses; both are kept as they stand. The text spells the swift one listed after Vyāghrīmukhā as "Sidha"; the next portion of the text describes her as lion-headed, so she is given as Siṃhamukhā. "Small corpse" renders a term that may refer to an infant's corpse or to the body of the enemy. "The sage" summoned to the fire is presumably Agni.
• "The place of the seat and the gathering" renders an obscure phrase (literally "the place of seat and ga na"), perhaps a sacred site or the gaṇacakra. In chapter thirteen, "on whom it lands" renders a phrase that literally reads "fallen on iron," which is unclear. The animal-headed names follow the Tibetan spellings (srin gla is taken as śṛgāla, "jackal" or "fox", matching the fox's head; kṛ ḍha as gṛdhra, "vulture").
• In the sixteenth and seventeenth chapters the syllable hūṃ stands for the wrathful deity Hūṃkāra, one of the ten wrathful ones named in the mantras of the fourteenth chapter. The ten deities identified from their mantras are Heruka, Hūṃkāra, Vijaya, Nīladaṇḍa, Yamāntaka, Acala, Hayagrīva, Aparājita, Amṛtakuṇḍalin, Trailokyavijaya, and Mahābala; the mudrā names follow these identifications (the "Neck" mudrā as Hayagrīva, the "Destroyer of Yama" as Yamāntaka). In the line on the head and the secret organ, mtshan is taken in its bodily sense rather than as a major mark; the line is terse. "Red arghya" (dmar) likely refers to an offering of blood or flesh.
• In chapters twenty-four to twenty-eight, dbang refers to the rite of magnetizing or bringing under control, one of the four ritual activities (pacifying, enriching, magnetizing, and fierce), not to empowerment. In the twenty-ninth chapter the verb mdzod is taken as an address to the Vajra of Pride. In the final paragraph, dang nyid kyis is read as rang nyid kyis, "of themselves."
• In the line on Amoghasiddhi the Tibetan reads "up to the left waist," although the parallel with Amitābha suggests "right"; it is translated as written. "She Who Is the Self of All" (thams cad bdag nyid ma), the consort set at the center beside Locanā, Māmakī, Pāṇḍaravāsinī and Tārā, is presumably Vairocana's consort, but the Sanskrit form of this name could not be identified with confidence, so it is translated literally. The phrase on the conch (sgo thams cad spa dgong bar) is rendered as sounding forth so as to overawe all the doors.
• The quatrain beginning "Coiling, and the ornaments, too, coiling" is terse and its sense uncertain; it is translated literally. The colophon's rdzogs sho is read as rdzogs so, "is complete." "His heart" is most naturally the heart of Vairocana, who has just spoken.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.